giffgaff

Accessibility

Why should we care?

- It’s the right thing to do
- Being accessible supports our core mission of being up to good
- It saves us time
- It helps in our B Corp journey
- It helps us tap into the Purple Pound

Types of disabilities

Permanent

- Blindness
- Cognitive impairment
- Colour vision deficiency
- Quadriplegia
- Deafness
- Motor skills impairments

Temporary

- Broken limb
- Broken mouse
- Broken glasses
- Sun glare on a screen
- Slow internet
- Cat on keyboard
- Under the influence

Semantics

Who does this help?
Absolutely everyone

What are semantics?
What code actually means

Information

- Using correct semantics adds an incredible amount of information, which can then be used by screen readers and web scrapers
- For instance, using a section element rather than a div element gives more meaning to your code. A web scraper can read our site better, improving our SEO.
- It saves us work in the long run, because we're using the extra features that are built in to each element, instead of having to build that functionality ourselves.

Alt text

What is alt text?
Short, descriptive text to describe an image.

Who does this help?
Anyone with visual impairments, and those with slow internet

Information

- It shouldn't start with 'An image of…' or 'A picture of…'
- For example, an image with alt text of 'A black cat sat on a brown sofa' will be read by a screen reader as 'Image. A black cat sat on a brown sofa'.
- Alt text should be used when an image is important to the meaning of the page. Decorative images don't need alt text, i.e. Doodles. Instead, alt text should be set as blank so that a screen reader will skip past it.

Tap Targets

What are tap targets?
Areas of a page that can be interacted with

Who does this help?
Anyone with motor skills impairments, including the elderly

Information

- Each tap target should be a minimum of 44px height and 44px width. However, the giffgaff standard is 48px height and 48px width.
- Where two tap targets are next to each other, there should be a minimum of an 8px gap between the two. However, the giffgaff standard is 16px

Colour Contrast

What is colour contrast?
Ensuring that text colour and background colour are different enough that the text is readable

Information

- How well one colour stands out from another determines whether people will be able to read the information
- The giffgaff colour palette has been designed to have sufficient colour contrast
- Search for ‘colour contrast checker’ for an easy tool to check that your colours are contrasting
- Use the giffgaff colour palette with the text colours as shown

Who does this help?
Everyone, but specifically anyone with colour vision deficiency, and those with sun glare on their screens



Link text

What is link text?
The text that is clickable for links and buttons

Who does this help?
Anyone with visual impairments, including the elderly

Information

- Every link or button should describe where the link or button will take you, in the clickable text
- Screen readers have the ability to jump from one link to the next, skipping all non-link text
- If all your links are ‘Click here’ or ‘Read more’, then that gives no information to the user about what that link will do
- For instance, instead of ‘Click here for a blog article’, use ‘A blog article’

Reading Age

What is reading age?
The reading level of the average person.

Who does this help?
Everyone, especially those with cognitive impairments

Information

- In the UK, the average reading age is 9 - 11 years old. This means that the average person reads at the same level as a 9 - 11 year old.
- This is not limited to the UK, in the USA the average reading age is 9 years old.
- At giffgaff, we aim to write for a reading age of 9, avoiding long and complicated words or sentences.

Pseudo-classes

Who does this help?
Everyone, especially those who use keyboards

What are pseudo-classes?
They define a special state of an element

Information

- These help to convey information
- Using a hover pseudo-class shows what a user has hovered their mouse over
- For keyboard-only users, they can't benefit from hover states. Instead, focus can be used with the same styling as hover to convey the same information - this is where your cursor is
- This is not just relevant for the web, as the app can be used on a tablet, with a keyboard and mouse attached

Demo

Using a screen reader on the app (android - TalkBack)

Demo

Using keyboard only on the web (no mouse)

Any questions?

Useful links

- Pa11y - An automated accessibility testing tool
- WebAIM's Colour Contrast Checker
- Keyboard only testing cheatsheet
- How to turn on TalkBack screen reader on android
- How to turn on VoiceOver on an iPhone
- Accessibility settings on Mac - Good for manual testing